



with stakeholders from fertiliser companies, such as IFFCO and FACT, which align with their organisational perspectives,” explains Devan.

The startup employs three primary strategies for its drones. First, it sells drones directly to farmers, who can offer drone services to others, becoming entrepreneurs. Second, it offers a service model for those who cannot afford the technology, charging ₹1000 to ₹5000 per acre for spraying and aerial mapping. Third, it expands through a dealer network. It partners with Kerala Agro Machinery Corporation (KAMCO) for Kerala, Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, and the northeastern states, as well as DroneHub Technologies for Andhra Pradesh and Intel Agro Solutions for Rajasthan, Gujarat, and Haryana.

The startup offers two pricing packages for its drones. The standard pack, priced at ₹500,000, includes one drone, one set of batteries, one charger, propellers, insurance, a one-year warranty, and an aluminium case. The combo pack, priced at ₹900,000, includes one drone, five sets of batteries, two extra chargers, additional nozzles, extra propellers, a one-year insurance policy, training, an aluminium case, and a one-year warranty.

As a startup working in the domain of sustainable agriculture, Fuselage is supported by UNDP India through its India High Range Mountain Landscape (IHRML) project in Kerala, with the

GEF, Green Innovation Fund, and Haritha Kerala Mission. Fuselage Innovations provided UAV/drone solutions for a specific tribal area. The pilot method of optimisation by Fuselage Innovations in one of the tribal areas in Idukki District, Kerala, resulted in significant savings in nutrient consumption of over 50% and an increase in yield by over 28%.

The startup employs 35 staff members and operates out of Kochi within Maker Village, one of India's largest electronic incubators. Fuselage Innovations currently has a monthly production capacity of 250 drones, with sales averaging 50 per month and 160 drones sold so far.

While highlighting the challenges, Devan shares that currently, the startup faces challenges due to a lack of skilled manpower and inadequate infrastructure, with 30-40% of resources procured externally. As market demand increases, they aim to address these infrastructure issues.

The company has recently expanded its operations to Canada and the UK, with the incorporation process completed in Canada and registration finalised in the UK. It is also in discussions with an agricultural university in the UK, marking the beginning of its overseas expansion.

Fuselage Innovations is incorporated with various organisations, including RPTOs, skill development centres, and Mahatma Gandhi University, to



Devan Chandrasekharan, Managing Director, Fuselage Innovations

provide training for its customers' stakeholders. The startup is also associated with PCB Aero Hub, which plays a vital role in training its stakeholders.

Fuselage Innovations received DGCA certification in late November 2023 and has sold around 70 drones across India. Initially, most demand came from Kerala, but recently, there has been increased interest from Andhra Pradesh, Karnataka, and Rajasthan.

In 2022, the company achieved a business turnover of ₹15 million. For 2023-24, this figure has risen to ₹55 million. Over the next two years, Fuselage Innovations aims to reach ₹350 million in business. Before 2022, the company primarily offered spraying services and crop analysis as part of a service model.

2 MUKUNDA FOODS: FROM QSR TO KITCHEN TECHNOLOGY EXPERT

Mukunda Foods, originally a QSR, evolved into a kitchen technology expert, simplifying kitchen operations through automation.

Established in 2012 by Eshwar K Vikas and Sudeep Sabat, engineering students and roommates at SRM University, Mukunda Foods Pvt Ltd began as a QSR

(quick-service restaurant) business in Bengaluru. However, facing delivery challenges due to its production process, they pivoted to develop their kitchen automation products to

enhance customer services.

Initially, they designed an automatic dosa-making machine, DosaMatic, which can prepare a *dosa* in one minute. The user only needs to place the batter in one container and oil in the other. As the company grew, it expanded its product line